

**TRIBAL TANF
WORK PARTICIPATION
RATE (WPR)
FEEDBACK
REFERENCE GUIDE**

(UPDATED SEPTEMBER 2026)

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About the Tribal TANF Work Participation Rate (WPR) Feedback Guide

This guide includes an overview of all WPR feedback reports, and each provides key details about the completeness and accuracy of the tribe's program data and how the program's work participation rate (WPR) was determined. We recommend reviewing these reports in the following order:

- Start with the [Cross-Section Check report](#). This report helps identify missing data or differences between sections that may affect the WPR calculation. For example, if more families are reported in Section 3 (Aggregate Data) than in Section 1 (Active Case Data), then families may be missing from the data used to calculate the WPR.
- Next, review the [Work Participation Rate \(WPR\) Monthly Calculation report](#). This report highlights the tribe's annual WPR and the rate for each reporting month of the fiscal year. It can help identify months where lower participation rates may have contributed to the tribe's overall fiscal year result.
- Then, review the [WPR Monthly Summary report](#). This report provides more detail on how the monthly WPR was calculated, including how many families were expected to participate, how many met the work requirement, and how exclusions were applied.
- Finally, review the [WPR Errors, Additional Work Activities](#), and [Invalid DOB reports](#), which include a list of cases, by reporting month, with inconsistent data that may be affecting your program's WPR results for the fiscal year. Correcting the data for these cases helps ensure your program's WPR results are complete and accurate. Please note: these reports are available only for programs where these types of data quality issues were detected.

Also included is additional guidance on [Reporting Work Sanctions in Active and Closed Case Data](#) and answers to [Frequently Asked Questions \(FAQs\)](#).

Cross-Section Check (Section 1 vs. Section 3) Report

Section	T202310	T202311	T202312	T202401	T202402	T202403	T202404	T202405	T202406	T202407	T202408	T202409
Section 1	47	45	47	43	44	43	46	43	51	48	45	48
Section 3	47	45	47	43	44	43	46	43	51	48	45	48
Discrepancy	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

i The **Cross-Section Check Report** helps identify missing data or differences between sections of the data report that may affect the WPR calculation.

This Report Answers...

- ? Were all families on the active caseload reported consistently across Section 1 (Active Case Data) and Section 3 (Aggregate Data)?
- ? Is there evidence that Section 1 (Active Case Data) data are missing?
- ? Are there months that require further review?

This report compares two sections of data to ensure these reflect the same number of families on the active caseload each month.

- Section 1: Detailed (disaggregated) data
- Section 3: Summary (aggregated) data

The cross-section check can have the following scenarios:

Scenario 1: No missing data and both sections reported the same number of families.

Section	T202310	T202311	T202312	T202401	T202402	T202403	T202404	T202405	T202406	T202407	T202408	T202409
Section 1	47	45	47	43	44	43	46	43	51	48	45	48
Section 3	47	45	47	43	44	43	46	43	51	48	45	48
Discrepancy	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

What the numbers show

- The **“Discrepancy”** row is **0** for all months, meaning there are **no differences**.
- It confirms the data is **consistent across reports**.
- It shows there are **no counting or reporting errors** between detailed and summary data.

Scenario 2: Some months of data are missing for both sections.

Section	T202310	T202311	T202312	T202401	T202402	T202403	T202404	T202405	T202406	T202407	T202408	T202409
Section 1	17	20	20	14	14	16	13	14	13	.	.	.
Section 3	17	20	20	14	14	16	13	14	13	.	.	.
Discrepancy	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	.	.	.

What the numbers show

- The last three months for both sections of data are missing ("." means there was no data). For this scenario, please submit both sections of missing data as soon as possible.

Scenario 3: There are discrepancies between sections, and one section of data is missing for last three months

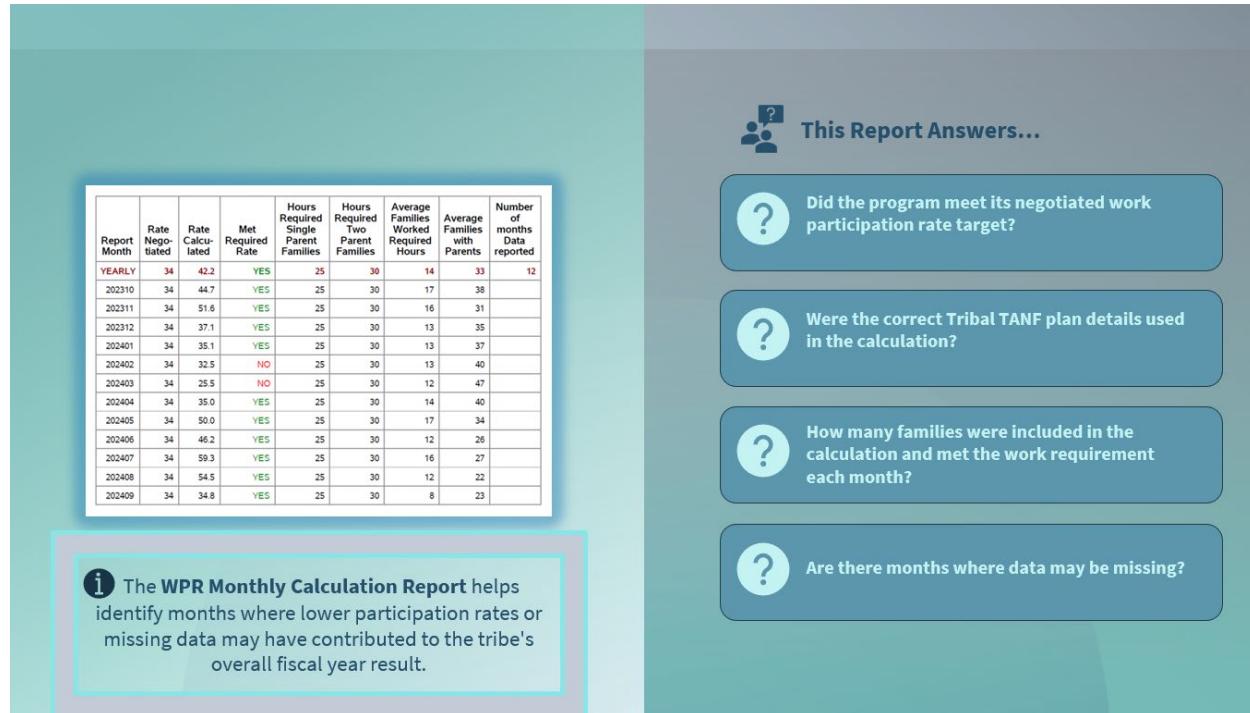
Section	T202310	T202311	T202312	T202401	T202402	T202403	T202404	T202405	T202406	T202407	T202408	T202409
Section 1	2	3	3	3	2	2	3	2	2	1	2	5
Section 3	3	4	4	4	3	3	4	3	3	.	.	.
Discrepancy	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	-1	1	2	5

What the numbers show

- The family case counts do NOT match between sections in every month of FY2024.
- For most months (Oct–Jun), Section 1 shows fewer families reported than in Section 3. This could be because data was not reported for one family in Section 1. Alternatively, 1 case from Section 1 was not processed or rejected during transmission to TDP. To be sure, please review any TDP error reports generated for the relevant fiscal periods; please also verify that family count reported in Section 1 is correct.
- In July to September, section 3 data is missing ("." means there was no data), either was not reported or rejected by TDP. Please review any TDP-generated error reports and submit the missing data as soon as possible.

Work Participation Rate (WPR) Monthly Calculation Report

This report shows a tribal TANF program's work participation performance for the fiscal year.



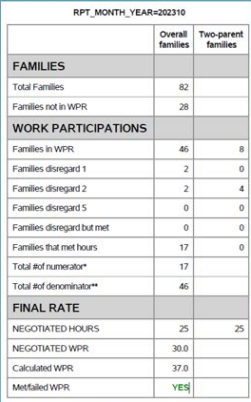
Please note the following key details about this program's rate, as reflected in their tribal TANF plan:

- the negotiated target rate per month is 34 percent
- single parent families must participate at least 25 hours per week in work activities
- two parent families must participate at least 30 hours per week in work activities

Based on data reported for FY2024:

- The program's yearly average work participation rate is 42.2, which is above the negotiated target rate of 34 percent.
- The program met or exceeded this negotiated target in 10 out of 12 months, with rates falling below the target in only February and March.
- The last column "Number of Months Data reported" equals 12, which means this program data was reported for all months of the fiscal year.

WPR Monthly Summary Report



RPT_MONTH_YEAR=202310

	Overall families	Two-parent families
FAMILIES		
Total Families	82	
Families not in WPR	28	
WORK PARTICIPATIONS		
Families in WPR	46	8
Families disregard 1	2	0
Families disregard 2	2	4
Families disregard 5	0	0
Families disregard but met	0	0
Families that met hours	17	0
Total #of numerator*	17	
Total #of denominator**	46	
FINAL RATE		
NEGOTIATED HOURS	25	25
NEGOTIATED WPR	30.0	
Calculated WPR	37.0	
Met/failed WPR	YES	

i The **WPR Monthly Summary Report** helps explain how many families were excluded from the monthly WPR calculation, why they were excluded, and how many families remained in the calculation.

This Report Answers...

- How many families were reported?
- How many families were included in the WPR calculation?
- How many families were excluded and why?
- Are there months that require further review?

This report includes a table for each month of the fiscal year that shows –of the families reported– the number of families expected to meet work requirements, and a breakdown of how many families met and did not meet this requirement.

As shown in the table below, in October 2023, this program met the negotiated work requirement:

Monthly WPR summary in FY2024

RPT_MONTH_YEAR=202310

	Overall families	Two-parent families
FAMILIES		
Total Families	82	
Families not in WPR	28	
WORK PARTICIPATIONS		
Families in WPR	46	8
Families disregard 1	2	0
Families disregard 2	2	4
Families disregard 5	0	0
Families disregard but met	0	0
Families that met hours	17	0
Total #of numerator*	17	
Total #of denominator**	46	
FINAL RATE		
NEGOTIATED HOURS	25	25
NEGOTIATED WPR	30.0	
Calculated WPR	37.0	
Met/failed WPR	YES	

Please note the following key details from this table:

- There were 82 total families reported for the month of October 2023
- 28 out of 82 families were not required to work because the family did not have an adult TANF recipient. These families are not considered in the work participation rate.
- Of the remaining 54 families considered in the month's work rate, 46 are single parent families, and 8 are two parent families. These families are expected to participate in 25 hours per week of work activities. Of these:
 - 17 one-parent families participated in the minimum number of hours for the all-family work rate
 - 0 two-parent families participated in the minimum number of hours for the all-family work rate
 - 2 families were disregarded from WPR because there was a child under 12 months in the family
 - 2 one-parent families and 4 two-parent families were disregarded because of a work sanction.
- The total families that met the required work hours = 17 (note: this is the numerator for the WPR)
- The total families considered in the work participation rate (note: this is the denominator for the WPR) = 54 – 8 (disregarded) = 46

Using these numbers:

- The work participation rate (WPR) is 37.0% (17 out of 46 families).
- The target (negotiated rate) is 30%, and the tribe met and exceed this target for October 2023.

WPR Errors Report

For each flag, an example case record is included for illustration. Columns highlighted in red correspond to the key data elements reported with inconsistent information. The last column (Overall Error or TP Error) is the error flag value. A description of each error flag, why it matters, and guidance on how these errors can be addressed are also included. Definitions of each column in the report tables are included in the report workbook (e.g., T###_WPR_Errors_FY2024.xlsx)

The following error flags are associated with families reported as having a **one-parent** family based on Item # 12: Family Type.

- **00 = Family type error**

month	caseid	FamilyType #12	Parent #39	HoH #38	age	WPS #48	youngest	work_SANC	EDempty	School	Req hours	Total Worked Hours	Overall Error
202402	1234	1	.	.	.	.	0.5	2	.	.	20	.	00

- *Description:* A family was reported as a one-parent family (i.e. Item #12 Family Type = 1: One-parent family), but no adult recipient parent or caretaker was reported for the family.
- *Why it matters:* Families reported as one-parent families but have no evidence of adult recipient parent/caretaker(s) are counted in the WPR calculation as not meeting the tribe's minimum work requirements because no work activity hours were reported for an adult recipient/caretaker.
- *What to do:* Review Item #12 (Family Type) to ensure that one-parent families with no adult recipients are reported as Item #12 = 3: Family excluded from WPR due to no adult recipient.

- **01 = Child Under 12 Months Disregard Reason Error**

month	caseid	FamilyType #12	Parent #39	HoH #38	age	WPS #48	youngest	work_SANC	EDemply	School	Req hours	Total Worked Hours	Overall Error
202401	0001	1	2	1	29.7	1	.	2	0	0	20	0	01
202404	0002	1	2	1	21.7	1	6	2	0	0	20	13	01

- *Description:* A family was reported as disregarded from work participation due to having a child under 12 months old (i.e. Item #48 = 1), but the youngest child reported for the family is older than 12 months, had an invalid DOB, or no child was reported for the family.
- *Why it matters:* When the disregard reason is not supported by related data, the family is included in the WPR calculation.
- *What to do:* Review Item #67 (Child DOB) and Item #48 (Work Participation Status) for the family to confirm whether the family had a child under 12 months old during the reporting month. If the family did have a child under 12 months old, correct the child's date of birth if needed. If the family did not have a child under 12 months old, correct Item #48 using the appropriate value from the Section 1: Active Case Data [coding instructions](#).

- **02 = Work Sanction Disregard Reason Error**

month	caseid	FamilyType #12	Parent #39	HoH #38	age	WPS #48	youngest	work_SANC	EDemply	School	Req hours	Total Worked Hours	Overall Error
202310	1234	1	2	1	31.6	2	6.2	2	0	0	20	0	02

- *Description:* A family was reported as disregarded from work participation due to a work sanction (i.e. Item #48 = 2), but the family's work requirement sanction status indicates that the family does not have a work requirement sanction (i.e. Item #26aai = 2:No).
- *Why it matters:* When the sanction disregard reason is not supported by related data, the family is included in the WPR calculation.
- *What to do:* Review Item #48 (Work Participation Status) and Item #26Aii (Work Requirement Sanction) to confirm whether the family had a work sanction during the reporting month. If the family was sanctioned due to work, correct Item #26Aii if needed. If the family was not sanctioned due to work, correct Item #48 using the appropriate value.

- **03 = Teen Deemed Engaged in Work due to School Attendance Error**

month	caseid	FamilyType #12	Parent #39	HoH #38	age	WPS #48	youngest	work_SANC	EDempty	School	Req hours	Total Worked Hours	Overall Error
202404	1234	1	3	4	28.9	15	12.8	2	0	0	25	0	03

- *Description:* An adult in the family was reported as deemed engaged in work due to satisfactory school attendance, but the data does not support this status. This may happen for one or more of the following reasons:
 - The adult is not a teen (between ages 13 and 19),
 - The adult is not a head-of-household (HoH) or spouse of HoH, and/or
 - The adult has zero hours of satisfactory school attendance reported.
- *Why it matters:* When the deemed engaged in work reason is not supported by related data, the family is counted as not meeting the work requirement.

- *What to do:* Review Item #32 (adult DOB), Item #38 (relationship to the head-of-household), and Item #59 (Satisfactory School Attendance for individuals without a high school diploma or equivalent) to confirm whether satisfactory school attendance should be reported for this person in Item #48 (Work Participation Status). Only teens who are head-of-household (or spouse of) with 1 or more hours of school attendances can be deemed engaged in work.

- **04 = Teen Deemed Engaged in Work due to Education Related to Employment Error**

month	caseid	FamilyType #12	Parent #39	HoH #38	age	WPS #48	youngest	work_SANC	EDemply	School	Req hours	Total Worked Hours	Overall Error
202406	12345	1	2	1	18.8	16	0	2	0	0	20	0	04

- *Description:* An adult in the family was reported as deemed engaged in work due to education related to employment, but the data does not support this status. This may happen for one or more of the following reasons:
 - The adult is not a teen (between ages 13 and 19),
 - The adult is not a head-of-household (HoH) or spouse of HoH, and/or
 - The adult has zero hours of education directly related to employment reported.
- *Why it matters:* When the deemed engaged in work reason is not supported by related data, the family is counted as **not** meeting the work requirement.
- *What to do:* Review Item #32 (adult DOB), Item #38 (relationship to the head-of-household), and Item #58 (Education Directly related to employment) to confirm whether education related to employment should be reported for this person in Item #48 (Work Participation Status). Only teens who are head-of-household (or spouse of) with 20 hours (or the minimum negotiated hours) of education related to employment can be deemed engaged in work.

- **05 = Deemed Engaged in Work with Child under 6 years old Error**

month	caseid	FamilyType #12	Parent #39	HoH #38	age	WPS #48	youngest	work_SANC	EDemply	School	Req hours	Total Worked Hours	Overall Error
202407	12345	1	2	1	27.9	17	3.5	2	0	0	20	0	05

- *Description:* A parent or caretaker relative in the family was reported as deemed engaged in work for at least 20 hours per week with a child under 6 years of age, but the youngest child in the family is older than 6, no child under 6 was reported for the family, or the minimum required hours were not reported.
- *Why it matters:* When the deemed engaged in work reason is not supported by related data, the family is counted as **not** meeting the work requirement.
- *What to do:* Review Item #67 (Child DOB) to determine whether the family has a child under 6 years of age during the reporting month. If so, please ensure the child's DOB is reported correctly. If not, then the appropriate value for Item # 48 (Work Participation Status) should be reported for this family. For families with children under 6 years of age, the family is *required* to participate in work activities for at least 20 hours per week or the minimum negotiated hours (whichever is smaller).

The following error flags are associated with families reported as having a **two-parent** family based on Item # 12: Family Type.

- **00 = Family type error**

month	caseid	Family Type #12	Req hours	Req 2p hours	P1 Parent #39	(other P1 data)	P2 Parent #39	(other P2 data)	youngest	work_SANC	TP Error
202404	3456	2	20	30	.	.	.	.	13.6	2	00
202310	5678	2	25	25	1	(not missing)	.	.	2.9	2	00

- *Description:* A family was reported as a two-parent family (i.e. Item #12 Family Type = 2: Two-parent family), but fewer than two parents receiving assistance were reported for the family.
- *Why it matters:* Families reported as two-parent families but have no evidence of adult recipient parent(s) are counted in the two-parent WPR calculation.
- *What to do:* Review Item #12 (Family Type) to ensure that families with no adult recipients are reported as Item #12 = 3 to exclude from work participation rate calculation; a family with only one adult recipient should be reported as Item #12=1 to be included in one-parent/overall WPR calculation.

- **01 = Child Under 12 Months Disregard Reason Error**

month	caseid	Family Type #12	Req 2_p hours	P1 Parent #39	P1 HoH #38	P1 age	P1 WPS #48	P1 Ed.Employ	P1 SchoolAttd.	P2 Parent #39	P2 HoH #38	P2 age	P2 WPS #48	P2 Ed.Employ	P2 SchoolAttd.	youngest	work_SANC	TP Error
202404	1234	2	40	1	2	30.2	19	0	0	1	1	30.1	1	0	0	1.4	2	01

- *Description:* At least one parent in a two-parent family was reported as disregarded from work participation due to having a child under 12 months old (i.e. Item #48 = 1), and the youngest child reported for the family is older than 12 months, had an invalid DOB, or no child was reported for the family.
- *Why it matters:* When the disregard reason is not supported by related data, the family is included in the 2-parent WPR calculation. Additionally, both parents in the family must have Item #48 = 1 to be disregarded from the 2-parent calculation.
- *What to do:* Review Item #67 (Child DOB) and Item #48 (Work Participation Status) for the family to confirm whether the family had a child under 12 months old during the reporting month. If the family did have a child under 12 months old, correct the child's date of birth if needed. If the family did not have a child under 12 months old, correct Item #48 using the appropriate value from the Section 1: Active Case Data [coding instructions](#).

- **02 = Work Sanction Disregard Reason Error**

month	caseid	Family Type #12	Req 2p hours	P1 Parent #39	P1 HoH #38	P1 age	P1 WPS #48	P1 Ed.Employ	P1 SchoolAttd.	P2 Parent#39	P2 HoH#38	P2 age	P2 WPS#48	P2 Ed.Employ	P2 SchoolAttd.	youngest	work_SANC	TP Error
202310	5678	2	40	1	1	29.7	2	0	0	1	2	30.2	2	0	0	5	2	02

- *Description:* A two-parent family was reported as disregarded from work participation due to a work sanction (i.e. Item #48 = 2), but the family's work requirement sanction status indicates that the family does not have a work requirement sanction (i.e. Item #26aai = 2:No).
- *Why it matters:* When the sanction disregard reason is not supported by related data, the family is included in the 2-parent WPR calculation.
- *What to do:* Review Item #48 (Work Participation Status) and Item #26Aii (Work Requirement Sanction) to confirm whether the family had a work sanction during the reporting month. If the family was sanctioned due to work, correct Item #26Aii if needed. If the family was not sanctioned due to work, correct Item #48 using the appropriate value.

- **03 = Teen Deemed Engaged in Work due to School Attendance Error**

month	caseid	Family Type #12	Req 2p hours	P1 Parent #39	P1 HoH #38	P1 age	P1 WPS #48	P1 Ed.Employ	P1 SchoolAttd.	P2 Parent #39	P2 HoH #38	P2 age	P2 WPS #48	P2 Ed.Employ	P2 SchoolAttd.	young est	work_SAN C	TP Error
202402	5678	2	30	1	1	16.7	15	0	0	1	10	18.2	15	0	0	0.6	2	03

- *Description:* At least one parent in the two-parent family was reported as deemed engaged in work due to satisfactory school attendance, but the data does not support this status. This may happen for one or more of the following reasons:
 - A parent is not a teen (between ages 13 and 19),
 - A parent is not a head-of-household (HoH) or spouse of HoH, and/or
 - A parent has zero hours of satisfactory school attendance reported.
- *Why it matters:* When the deemed engaged in work reason is not supported by related data, this parent cannot deem the hours for school attendance.
- *What to do:* Review Item #32 (adult DOB), Item #38 (relationship to the head-of-household), and Item #59 (Satisfactory School Attendance for individuals without a high school diploma or equivalent) to confirm whether satisfactory school attendance should be reported for this person in Item #48 (Work Participation Status). Only teens who are head-of-household (or spouse of) with 1 or more hours of school attendances can be deemed engaged in work.

- **04 = Teen Deemed Engaged in Work due to Education Related to Employment Error**

month	caseid	Family Type #12	Req 2p hours	P1 Parent #39	P1 HoH #38	P1 age	P1 WPS #48	P1 Ed.Employ	P1 School Attd.	P2 Parent #39	P2 HoH #38	P2 age	P2 WPS #48	P2 Ed.Employ	P2 School Attd.	young est	work_SA NC	TP Error
202409	1234	2	30	1	1	23.1	16	0	0	1	10	35.1	17	0	0	2.2	2	04

- *Description:* At least one parent in the two-parent family was reported as deemed engaged in work due to education-related employment, but the data does not support this status. This may happen for one or more of the following reasons:
 - A parent is not a teen (between ages 13 and 19),
 - A parent is not a head-of-household (HoH) or spouse of HoH, and/or
 - A parent has zero hours of education-related employment reported.
- *Why it matters:* When the deemed engaged in work reason is not supported by related data, this parent cannot deem the hours for education-related employment.
- *What to do:* Review Item #32 (adult DOB), Item #38 (relationship to the head-of-household), and Item #58 (Education Directly Related to Employment) to confirm whether education-related employment should be reported for this person in Item #48 (Work Participation Status). Only teens who are head-of-household (or spouse of) with 20 hours (or the minimum negotiated hours) of education related to employment can be deemed engaged in work.

- **05 = Deemed Engaged in Work with Child under 6 years old Error**

month	caseid	Family Type #12	Req 2p hours	P1 Parent #39	P1 HoH #38	P1 age	P1 WPS #48	P1 Ed.Employ	P1 SchoolAttd.	P2 Parent#39	P2 HoH#38	P2 age	P2 WPS #48	P2 Ed.Employ	P2 SchoolAttd.	youngest	work_SANC	TP Error
202310	6789	2	30	1	1	33.8	17	0	0	1	10	27.6	19	0	0	0.7	2	05

- *Description:* At least one parent or caretaker relative in a two-parent family was reported as deemed engaged in work for at least 20 hours per week with a child under 6 years of age, which is only applicable to 1-parent families.
- *Why it matters:* In two-parent families, neither parent/caretaker can be deemed engaged in work for at least 20 hours per week with a child under 6 years of age because this only applies to one-parent families. The work activity hours for each parent/caretaker will be used to determine if the family is meeting the tribe's requirements for two-parent families.
- *What to do:* Determine the appropriate value for Item # 48 (Work Participation Status) for each parent. Also, review Item #12 (Family Type) and #39 (Parent of Minor Child) for each parent to ensure consistency.

Additional Work Activities Report

This report includes a list of cases, by reporting month, where additional work activities were reported for Item #61 Additional Work Activities, which is not applicable for Tribal TANF programs. These work activity hours are not considered in work participation calculations. If the Tribe's approved plan contains additional work activities, the total average hours per week for these activities should be reported for Item #62 Other Work Activities.

FY2024 Cases with more than 0 hours in ADD_WORK_ACTIVITIES (DM#61 no longer in use)			
CASE_NUMBER (Item #6)	RPT_MONTH_YEAR (Item #4)	ADD_WORK_ACTIVITIES (Item #61)	OTHER_WORK_ACTIVITIES (Item #62)
1234	202311	23	0

In the example case record above, 23 hours of Item #61 (Additional Work Activities) were reported for an adult recipient in the family, and 0 hours of Item #62 (Other Work Activities) were reported. Hours reported for Item #61 will not be considered in the WPR calculation.

Invalid Date of Birth (DOB) Report

Contains a list of TANF recipients, by case and reporting month, with potentially invalid DOBs. This list is based on an age estimate, which considers the individual's DOB, the first day of the reporting month, and a standard statistical approximation (dividing by 365.25).

Adult recipients with invalid DOB or age<12

RPT_MONTH_YEAR (Item #4)	CASE_NUMBER (Item #6)	Age	DATE_OF_BIRTH (Item #32)
202310	123	8.4	2016MMDD
202310	456	5.1	2018MMDD

Child recipients with invalid DOB or age>19

RPT_MONTH_YEAR (Item #4)	CASE_NUMBER Item #6	Age	DATE_OF_BIRTH Item #32
202401	5678	19.1	2004MMDD

Please verify that the DOB is correct. An invalid DOB is flagged when the date of birth is not formatted as YYYYMMDD. Invalid DOBs can affect work participation calculations that rely on the age of the adult recipient and/or youngest child in the family.

- For individuals on the adult list, recipients less than 12 years of age are unexpected for minor heads of household.
- For individuals on the child list, recipients older than 19 years of age are unexpected.

Reporting Work Sanctions in Active and Closed Case Data

(September 2026)

Background

When reviewing a WPR Errors Report, some partners may see an error related to how work requirement sanctions were reported. This happens when a family is reported as disregarded from work participation for the month due to a sanction, but the sanction information reported for that same month does not show that the family has a work requirement sanction. This type of error is called *Error Flag 02: Work Sanction Disregard Error* (see [WPR Errors Report](#)).

Through discussions about this error with Tribal TANF programs, ACF has learned that some programs track the month of noncompliance separately from the month when the resulting sanction is in effect. For example, a family may not meet the work requirements in one month, while the consequence of that noncompliance—such as a reduction in assistance or case closure—takes effect in a later month. Because these events may occur in different months, it is important to distinguish the month of noncompliance from the month that the sanction is in effect for federal reporting purposes.

The guidance below explains when and how a work requirement sanction should be reported, including common scenarios that may lead to *Error Flag 02*. Programs may track noncompliance and sanctions differently in their case management systems. This guidance does not prescribe how programs should track these events internally; it addresses only how sanction-related information should be reported in the Tribal TANF Data Report.

When should a sanction be reported?

For federal reporting purposes, **a work requirement sanction should be reported for the month(s) when the family is being penalized**, not an earlier month when the noncompliance occurred. This interpretation is based on [45 CFR § 286.85\(c\)\(2\)\(i\)](#), which refers to families being excluded or disregarded from the work participation rate calculation when penalized for noncompliance “*in that month*.”

- If the family remains on the active caseload and its assistance is reduced, the sanction should be reported in the Section 1 (active case) data report for the month the reduction is in effect.
- If the case closes because of the sanction, the case should be reported in the Section 2 (closed case) data for the family’s last month of assistance, with Item #9 (Reason for Closure) = 04: Work-related sanction.

The scenarios below illustrate how this guidance applies when a family remains active and when a case closes because of a work-related sanction.

Scenario 1: Case remains active and assistance is reduced

A family does not meet the work requirements in April 2026. The sanction is processed in May 2026, and the family's assistance is reduced in June 2026. The family remains on the active caseload.

For federal reporting purposes:

- *April 2026:* Report the details of the family's case based on what occurred in April. Because the sanction was not yet in effect, do not report the family as disregarded due to a work sanction for this month.
- *May 2026:* Report the details of the family's case based on what occurred in May. Because the sanction was not yet in effect, do not report the family as disregarded due to a work sanction for this month.
- *June 2026:* Report the family in Section 1 (active case) data. Report Item #26a(ii) (Work Requirement Sanction) = 1: Yes. If the family is being disregarded from the work participation rate because of the sanction, report Item #48 (Work Participation Status) = 2

Scenario 2: Case closes because of the sanction

A family does not meet the work requirements in April 2026. The program reviews the April noncompliance in May 2026, and the resulting work-related sanction leads to the case closing in June 2026. May 2026 is the family's last month of assistance.

For federal reporting purposes:

- *April 2026:* Report the details of the family's case based on what occurred in April. Because the sanction was not yet in effect, do not report the family as disregarded due to a work sanction for this month.
- *May 2026:* Report the details of the family's case based on what occurred in May. Because May is the family's last month of assistance, report the case in Section 2 (closed case) data for May 2026 and report Item #9 (Reason for Closure) = 04: Work-related sanction.
- *June 2026:* The family is no longer reported to ACF at all—neither in Section 1 nor Section 2—because the case has closed.

Scenario 3: Family meets the work requirement during the sanction month

A family does not meet the work requirements in April 2026. The program processes a sanction in May 2026, and the family's assistance is reduced in June 2026. However, the family meets its work requirement for June 2026.

For federal reporting purposes:

- *April 2026:* Report the details of the family's case based on what occurred in April. Because the sanction was not yet in effect, do not report the family as disregarded due to a work sanction for this month.
- *May 2026:* Report the details of the family's case based on what occurred in May. Because the sanction was not yet in effect, do not report the family as disregarded due to a work sanction for this month.
- *June 2026:* For Item #48 (Work Participation Status), the family may be reported as disregarded due to the work sanction or as meeting the work requirement. The federal WPR calculation also considers the family's reported work activity hours. If those hours show that the family is meeting the work requirement, the family will be counted as meeting the requirement; otherwise, a family with a validated disregard reason will be excluded from the WPR calculation.

Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

1. Which families are excluded from the WPR, and how are these families reported?

Generally, families receiving assistance are expected to participate in work activities and are included in the WPR calculation unless the reported data support a valid reason for exclusion. There are four valid reasons a family may be excluded. The examples below show the key reported data used to validate each exclusion reason.

- **Families with no adult recipients** are excluded from the WPR. These families are identified by a value of **3** for Item #12 (Family Type).

Item #4: Reporting Year and Month	Item #6: Case Number	Item #12: Family Type
202410	1234	3:no adult receiving assistance

- **Families with a reported disregard due to having a child under age 1 yr** are excluded from the WPR. These families are identified by a value of 1 for Item #48 (Work Participation Status). The age of the youngest child in the family, based on Item #67 (Child DOB) during the reporting month, is used to verify that the child was under age 1.

Item #4: Reporting Year and Month	Item #6: Case Number	Item #12: Family Type	Item #48: Work Participation Status	Item #67 Child DOB
202410	1234	1: One- parent or 2: Two- parent	1: disregard due to child under 1 yr	2024-08- 01

- **Families with an active work sanction** are excluded from the WPR. These families are identified by a value of 2 for Item #48 (Work Participation Status). Item #26Aii (Work Requirement Sanction) is used to verify that a work sanction was reported for the family during the reporting month.

Item #4: Reporting Year and Month	Item #6: Case Number	Item #12: Family Type	Item #26Aii: Work Requirement Sanction	Item #48: Work Participation Status
202410	1234	1: One- parent or 2: Two- parent	1: Yes	2: disregard due to sanction

- **Families with a plan-defined disregard reason** are excluded from the WPR. These families are identified by a value of 5 for Item #48 (Work Participation Status). The family should meet a disregard reason described in the Tribe's approved TANF plan

Item #4: Reporting Year and Month	Item #6: Case Number	Item #12: Family Type	Item #48: Work Participation Status
202410	1234	1: One- parent or 2: Two- parent	5: disregard due to plan- defined reason

2. If a program meets its negotiated WPR target for the year but has WPR errors, should the errors still be reviewed and corrected? How could corrections affect the program's WPR?

Your program's calculated WPR reflects the data as reported, including any errors. If your program met its negotiated WPR target but errors were detected, reviewing the error-related feedback and making corrections, where appropriate, is still encouraged to help ensure that complete and accurate data have been submitted. These corrections could improve the program's WPR.

3. How should a work sanction be reported when the family's noncompliance and the resulting sanction occur in different months?

For federal reporting, report the sanction based on **when the sanction takes effect**, not the earlier month when the noncompliance occurred. If the family remains active and its assistance is reduced, report the sanction in Section 1 (Active Case Data) for the month the reduction is in effect. If the sanction closes the case, report the case in Section 2 (Closed Case Data) for the

family's last month of assistance and use the work-related sanction closure reason. See [Reporting Work Sanctions in Active and Closed Case Data](#) for examples of these scenarios.

4. What is the difference between a TDP error report and a WPR feedback report, and how are these reports related?

A [TDP Error Report](#) is generated when quarterly data do not align with the [Tribal TANF Data Reporting Instructions](#). It helps programs identify record-level data issues to review and correct.

A [WPR Feedback Report](#) is produced separately by the TANF data team and looks across the fiscal year. It shows how the reported data were used in the federal WPR calculation and highlights WPR-related results and data quality issues that may affect the rate.

These reports are related because data quality issues identified during submission can affect the data available for the WPR calculation. For example, if submitted records are not successfully processed, families may be missing from the data used to calculate the WPR. Learn more about [TDP Submission History](#).